



THE BUDDHA VILLA RETREAT

A guided plant medicine journey.

Love · Happiness · Freedom

CAPE TOWN · SOUTH AFRICA

*"The medicine opens the door.
What you bring to it shapes
what walks **through**."*

— CHENEY, FOUNDER

WHAT THIS IS

A six-day residential retreat in Cape Town.

The Buddha Villa Retreat is a six-day residential programme held at a private villa in Camps Bay, Cape Town. Twelve guests at a time. Practitioner-led. Built around three guided plant medicine ceremonies, woven into a structure of teaching, rest, conversation, and integration.

It is held with the seriousness of a clinical programme and the warmth of a private retreat. Every guest is screened. Every ceremony is held by experienced facilitators. Preparation begins weeks before arrival, and integration support continues long after departure.

Not a wellness break. Not a workshop. A contained, professionally facilitated environment for deep personal work. People come here to do something specific, then leave with a structure for living what they found.

THIS GUIDE

*A document to **sit** with.
Not skim.*

It walks slowly through the retreat: who comes, what the medicine asks, how the week is held, what supports the work before and after.

Read the way you would prepare for the journey itself. Slowly. With attention.

01

THE QUESTION

*Before the door, the
question.*

SIT WITH THIS FOR A MOMENT

Are you looking for clarity, or healing?

Most people come for one of the two. Most discover, somewhere in the week, that they came for both.

The answer is not a label. It is a signal. It indicates a lot about how the journey will unfold for you, what the ceremonies will surface, and what integration will ask of you on the other side.

THE FIRST JOURNEY

If you came for clarity.

The fog is the problem. You have outgrown a chapter and can't yet see the next one. A decision is waiting. A direction is asking to be named. A purpose feels close, but not close enough to hold.

The clarity journey is about cutting through. Ceremony tends to bring it sharp and quiet. You leave with fewer questions, not more answers, but the questions you keep are the right ones.

WHAT THE JOURNEY OFTEN SURFACES

A direction you'd been avoiding naming.

A truth about a relationship or commitment.

A purpose that has been there all along.

A decision the body already knew.

THE SECOND JOURNEY

If you came for healing.

Something is held in the body that the mind has not been able to move. Grief that did not get to grieve. A relationship that did not get to be named. A version of yourself you had to abandon to survive.

The healing journey is slower and quieter than people expect. Ceremony does not push. It opens, and what needs to come up comes up. The work is in being present for it, and being held while it moves.

WHAT THE JOURNEY OFTEN SURFACES

A grief never properly named.

A pattern in relationships that keeps repeating.

A part of yourself you have not forgiven.

An old fear the body is finally ready to release.

THE TWO JOURNEYS

*In time, the two **become** the **same**.*

Most who come for clarity find that the fog was a wound. Most who come for healing find clarity waiting on the other side of the work.

You do not need to know which one you are here for. You only need to be honest about which one you started with. The medicine and the framework will hold the rest.

The signal matters more than the label. What you tell us in screening shapes how your week is held, the support you are paired with, and the integration we offer afterward.

*"You arrive **carrying**. You
leave **clearer**."*

— A GUEST, PAST COHORT

02

THE SETTING

A villa briefed for one purpose.

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CAMPS BAY · CAPE TOWN

THE BUDDHA VILLA

*The Atlantic on one side. The mountains on the **other**.*

A private villa set against the Twelve Apostles in Camps Bay. Communal spaces, private rooms, outdoor decks, a pool that opens onto the ocean. The villa is fully briefed and held. There is no friction, no logistics, nothing to manage.

Guests arrive and the only thing asked of them is presence. The space takes care of everything else.

Twelve people. One house. One shared week.

Small enough that every person is seen, held, and known by name through the week.



THE BUDDHA VILLA · CAMPS BAY





THE POOL, THE ATLANTIC BEYOND



THE KITCHEN, THE LONG TABLE



THE DECK, THE PERGOLA

*The room is **built**. The week is
held. The only thing asked of
you is to **arrive**.*

03

THE MEDICINE

*The door,
and what it asks of you.*

IN PLAIN TERMS

*What we mean by **plant medicine**.*

Plant medicine is a plant-based preparation, used inside guided ceremony, to support the kind of inner work most people never have a structured way to do. It has a long lineage, far older than any modern wellness movement, and it is treated with the seriousness of that lineage at this retreat.

Used properly, it can dissolve the defences a person has spent decades building, and let them see clearly what is underneath. It does not give you answers. It removes what was in the way of seeing them.

It is not recreational. It is not a shortcut. It is a tool, held inside a framework, used with care.

Plain-language facts:

- Taken once per ceremony, three ceremonies over the week.
- Always with experienced facilitators present.
- Each guest is medically and psychologically screened before acceptance.
- No phone, no work, no outside distractions during ceremony.

THE APPROACH

A doorway. Not a destination.

The medicine does the opening. The work is what you do with the door once it is open. That work happens in the teaching, the fire circles, the silence, and the integration that follows. The ceremony is one part of a much larger container.

This is why the Foundation builds the retreat around the medicine, not in service of it. Preparation, teaching, rest, conversation, integration. All of these are weighted equally with the ceremonies themselves.

The medicine doesn't give answers. It removes what was in the way of seeing them. The seeing is yours to do.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS

A ceremony, in *practical* terms.

For most corporate guests, this is unfamiliar territory. Here is what a ceremony actually looks like at the Buddha Villa.

01 *A held indoor space*

A purpose-prepared room with mats, blankets, pillows, and soft light. Each guest has their own space. No phones, no clocks, no outside contact.

02 *The medicine is taken at the start*

Guests take the medicine seated, in silence, in turn. Then they return to their space. The effect builds over the next hour.

03 *Music guides the journey*

Live or curated music carries the experience for several hours. Most guests spend the time lying down with eyes closed, moving through the inner work.

04 *Facilitators are present the whole time*

Experienced practitioners stay in the room from start to finish. They support each guest individually as needed. No one is alone with the experience.

05 *Morning after — integration circle*

A held conversation the next morning. Guests share what came up if they wish to. Practitioners help frame what was felt into something a person can carry forward.

SAFETY

How the space is held.

Plant medicine is only as safe as the container around it. The Foundation builds that container deliberately, in four layers.

01 *Screening before acceptance*

Every guest completes a medical and psychological screening. Certain conditions and medications make the medicine unsafe. The Foundation says no when it isn't right.

02 *Experienced, professional facilitation*

Ceremonies are led by practitioners with years of experience holding this work. The team includes medical support on call for the duration of every ceremony.

03 *A small, known cohort*

Twelve guests, no more. Small enough that the facilitators know what each person is carrying, and can hold accordingly.

04 *Framework before and after*

Preparation in the weeks before. Integration in the weeks after. The ceremony sits inside a structure, never on its own.

A doorway, not a destination.

— ON THE MEDICINE

04

THE JOURNEY

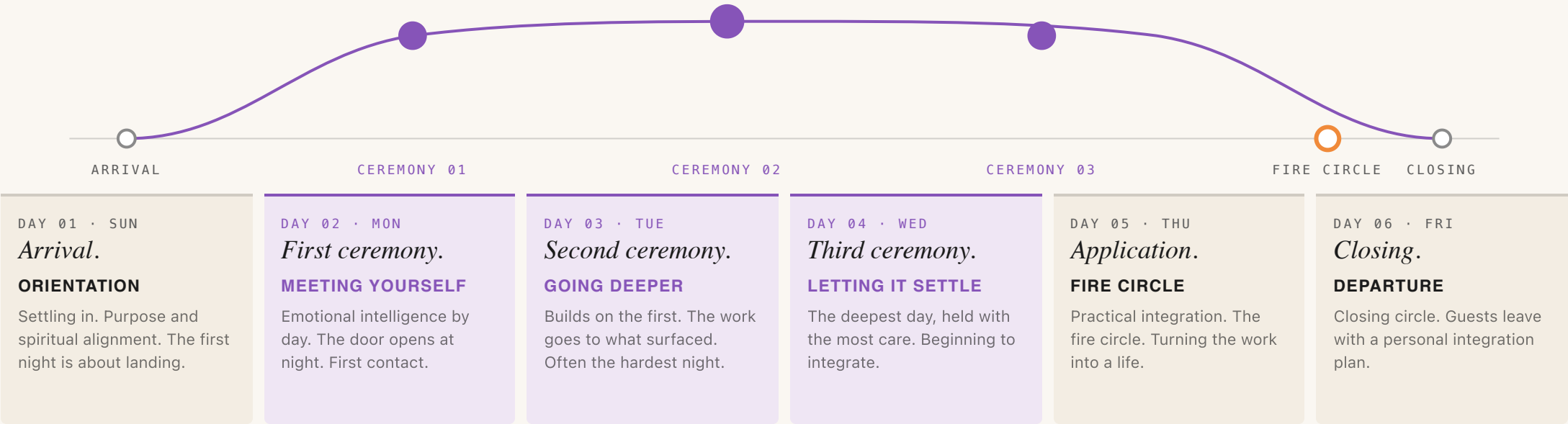
*Six days, built as an **arc**.*

LOVE · HAPPINESS · FREEDOM

SUNDAY THROUGH FRIDAY

THE SIX-DAY ARC

A structure that *builds*, then *settles*.



Ceremonies are not stacked back to back. Each is followed by a day of teaching and rest so the body and mind can metabolise before the next.

A DAY IN THE RHYTHM

The hours between the ceremonies.

06:30

Sit before the day arrives.

Twenty minutes of stillness. No phones.

08:00

Yoga and movement.

Bodywork before the mind shows up.

10:00

Teaching, a pillar in depth.

Group work. Real conversations.

13:00

Long table lunch.

Food cooked at the villa. The community forms here.

15:00

A long walk, mostly in silence.

The morning's work settles.

19:00

Fire circle, or ceremony.

Depending on the day. The centre of the week.

Rest is not a gap in the programme. It is part of the programme. The work needs space to land.

By the third day, most guests stop checking the time. The rhythm carries them. That is the point.

THE THREE CEREMONIES

*Each one goes **further** than the last.*

01 *Monday — meeting yourself*

The first ceremony is about contact. Most guests meet a version of themselves they have been avoiding. The facilitators hold steady. Nothing is forced.

02 *Tuesday — moving through it*

The second ceremony builds on the first. With the door already open, the work goes deeper into what surfaced. Often the hardest night, and the most important.

03 *Wednesday — letting it settle*

The third ceremony is held with the most care. It is less about opening and more about integration, about beginning to carry what was found back into the body.

*"Between every ceremony, the
space to **metabolise** what was
found."*

— ON THE RHYTHM OF THE WEEK

05

THE ARC BEYOND THE WEEK

*The retreat is six days.
The **work** is longer.*

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PREPARATION · INTEGRATION · COMPANION

BEFORE YOU ARRIVE

*Preparation begins **weeks** out.*

What a guest brings to the ceremony shapes what the ceremony can do.

So the work starts before arrival. In the weeks leading up, guests are guided to slow down: eat lighter, sleep more, sit quietly, pay attention to what they are carrying.

The Foundation provides a structured preparation guide, plus access to NAVID (the Foundation's AI companion) for the lead-up.

Preparation is the first ceremony. The week at the villa simply continues what the preparation begins.

AFTER YOU LEAVE

*Integration is where the lesson becomes a **life**.*

Guests leave with an integration plan: slow mornings, journaling, breathwork, walks, conversations. The ceremony opens the door. Integration walks you through it. This is where the real change holds or fades.

Integration is supported by the Foundation for as long as the guest needs it. Through scheduled check-ins, through community, and through the technology layer described on the next pages.

The Foundation does not disappear on Friday. Support carries through the months after the retreat.

06

THE COMPANION

*A custom technology layer
that **holds** the work.*

NAVID

An AI companion, built for this work.

NAVID is a custom AI companion, built end-to-end by the Foundation's technology partner, Divergence. It is not a generic chatbot. It was trained on the Foundation's curriculum, the rhythm of a retreat, the tone of the work, and the patterns guests actually carry.

Every retreat guest gets access. NAVID supports preparation before arrival, holds the space between sessions during the week, and walks alongside through the weeks of integration after. It remembers conversations. It calibrates to where you are.

It is locked. Only retreat guests and Foundation members have access.

**NAVID**

ONLINE • REPLIES INSTANTLY

I'm anxious about the week ahead.

Anxiety often shows up loudest when something matters. What part feels heaviest right now?

I think I'm afraid of what will come up.

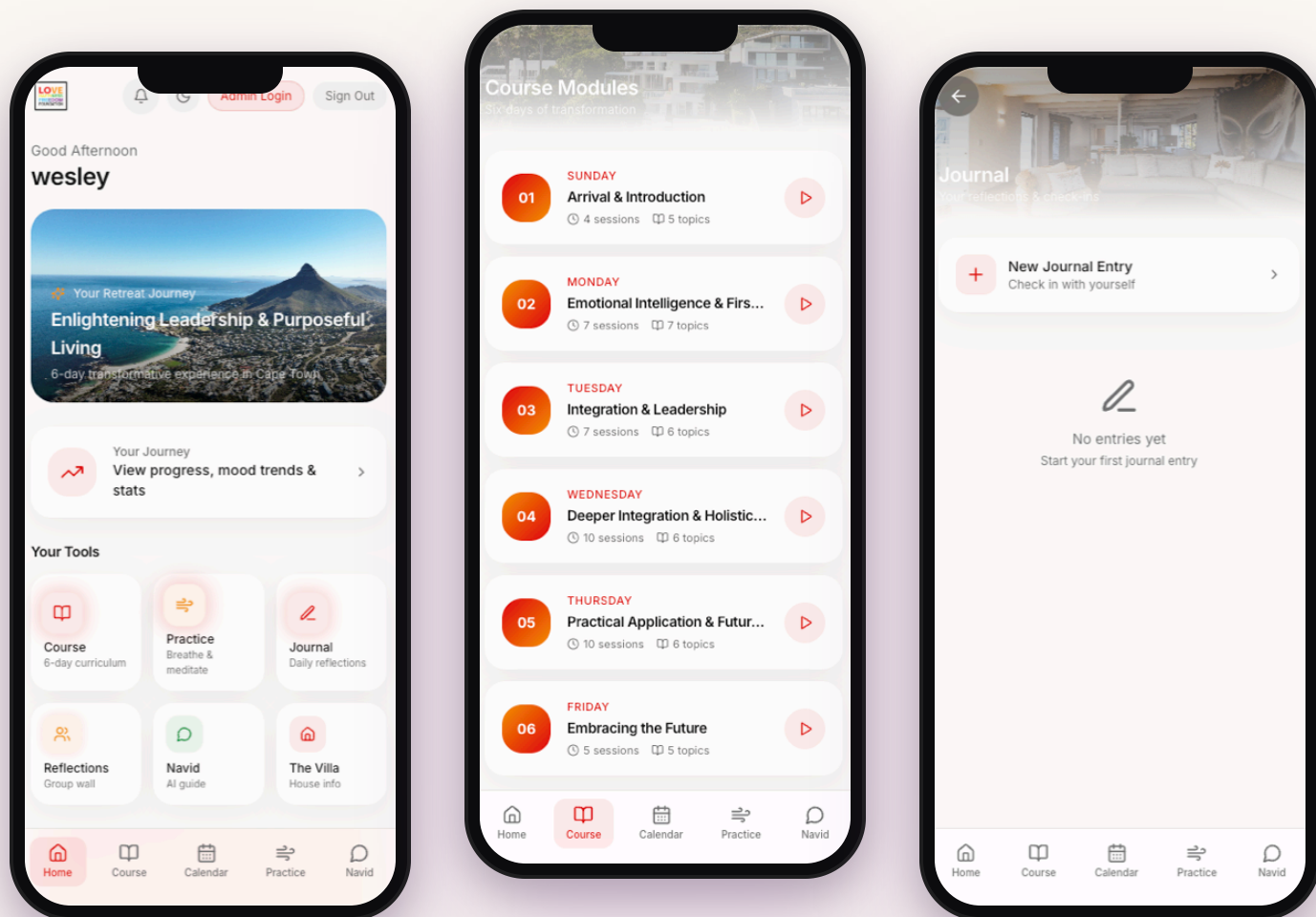
That fear is doing its job. What would it mean for you if it came up safely?

THE FOUNDATION APP

The retreat in your pocket.

Every retreat guest gets the Foundation's companion app. Built end-to-end by Divergence on iOS and Android. It carries the seven pillars curriculum, a private encrypted journal, a daily practice tracker, NAVID, and a quiet community for past guests.

The app is a working tool, not a marketing piece. Guests are encouraged to use it daily during preparation, never during ceremony, and consistently through integration.



WHAT'S INSIDE

Five tools, *well*.

01 · HOME

Your daily dashboard

What's next, what's been done. A calm overview of the day's work.

02 · COURSES

The seven pillars, on repeat

Audio lessons, written practices, short videos. Each pillar broken into weeks.

03 · JOURNAL

Write what's true

A private journal, encrypted on device. Daily prompts, weekly reflections.

04 · PRACTICE

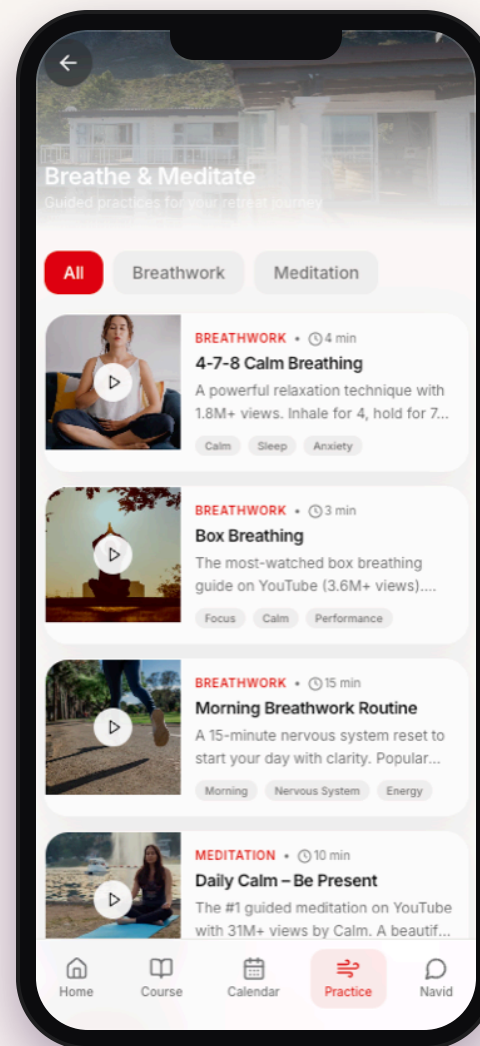
A streak that matters

Meditation, breathwork, movement, journaling. Quietly tracked.

05 · NAVID

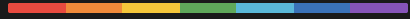
Your AI companion, built in

Tap the corner of any screen. NAVID is there. Trained on the curriculum, available across the full arc.



*The medicine opens the door.
You walk **through**. The
Foundation walks **with** you.*

— THE LOVE HAPPINESS FREEDOM FOUNDATION



A GUIDE TO THE JOURNEY

The Buddha Villa Retreat.

Take this with you. Sit with it. The next step finds you when it is yours to take.

Love · Happiness · Freedom

CAPE TOWN · SOUTH AFRICA